

The Synod of Endings: The Bureaucracy of the Pinnacle

****Concept:**** The Plane of Record, Judgment, and Interplanar Transit.

****Visuals:**** An infinite metropolitan sprawl composed of the ****Pinnacles**** of destroyed structures—perfect, pristine versions of buildings lost in the material world.

****Role:**** The administrative capital of the afterlife.

****Replaces:**** the silent athenaeum and the concordance

1. The Triad of Administration (The Custodians)

The souls here are not idle; they are employed based on the deity they served in life. They maintain the plane's function as a massive processing engine.

*** **The Clerks & Counsel (Followers of Vestus):****

****Roles:**** Librarians, Catalogers, Historians, and Lawyers.

*** **Function:**** They manage the ****Data****. When a soul arrives or a building manifests, the Vestusians catalog its history and significance. In the courts of the dead, they act as both prosecutors (revealing secrets) and defense attorneys (citing historical precedent). They ensure every "File" is accurate.

*** **The Administration (Followers of Nomos):****

****Roles:**** Judges, Bureaucrats, Administrators, and Clerical Staff.

*** **Function:**** They manage the ****Process****. They review the files prepared by the Vestusians and issue judgments. They assign housing, approve interplanar transit visas, and manage the zoning of the infinite city. They ensure the "Great Machine" runs without error.

*** **The Enforcers (Followers of Moros):****

****Roles:**** Police, Custodians, Janitors, and Wardens.

*** **Function:**** They manage the ****Physicality****. They patrol the streets to prevent unauthorized movement (police), repair the pristine buildings (janitors), and escort souls to their final destinations (custodians). They ensure the sanctity of the plane is maintained and that "dirt" (chaos/corruption) is swept away.

2. Architecture: The Function of Lost Forms

The buildings that appear here retain a conceptual function similar to their original purpose, but elevated to a cosmic scale.

*** **Temples = Embassies:**** A destroyed temple of Aurelion becomes the ****Embassy of Sovereignty****. It is sovereign ground for that deity. Souls sorted to Aurelion's realm gather here for transport, and diplomatic envoys from the Crucible of Kings reside here.

*** **Palaces = Seats of Administration:**** A destroyed royal palace becomes a ****Department Headquarters****. The "Palace of the Sun King" might now be the "Department of Vital Statistics," where high-ranking undead administrators (Liches/Vampires) oversee the processing of new arrivals.

*** **Homes = Domiciles:**** Destroyed houses, manors, and apartments provide housing for the plane's permanent workforce (the Custodians) and temporary housing for souls awaiting processing. Your status in the afterlife bureaucracy often dictates the quality of your assigned "eternal home."

*** **Banks & Markets = Interplanar Ports:**** Destroyed centers of commerce act as ****Transit Hubs****.

* *Function:* These are not for processing souls, but for **travel and trade**. A destroyed Transit port becomes a portal to **The Borderlands**, allowing the trade of goods and planar materials. A destroyed forest or environment might link to **The Verdant Font**, allowing the import of life-essence (regulated by Moros's customs officers).

3. Vestus and the Library of Naked Truths

You specified that secrets are hidden in plain sight. This transforms the "Library" aspect of the plane into a terrifying labyrinth of data overload.

* **The Archives:** Every secret, every stolen truth, and every "file" is available on the shelves.

* **The Needle in the Haystack:** The defense is **Volume and Context**. A specific secret (e.g., "Who killed the King?") is buried alongside billions of mundane, useless secrets and information ("What did a peasant in Era 2 eat for breakfast?").

* **The Barrier:** Without the correct **Index**, an outsider looking for a secret will simply drown in irrelevant data.

* **The "Useless" Truths:** As you noted, much of the library is filled with the "petty sins" of billions of mortals—cheating peasants, small lies, forgotten debts. This "noise" creates a camouflage that hides the "signal" of cosmic secrets.

4. The Nature of the Undead (vs. Ghosts)

This distinction creates a clear mechanical and narrative rule for your setting.

* **The Residents (Sanctioned Undead):** The Custodians (Vestus/Nomos/Moros followers) are "Sanctioned Undead." They have been processed, given a role, and sustained by the plane's energies. They have purpose and continuity.

* **Ghosts:** As per your sidebar, Ghosts are **not** present here. Ghosts are souls that **refused** the call to the Synod/Palimpsest. They remain in the Material Plane as entities of pure Aetherium, sustained by unresolved business or trauma.

* **Interaction:** If a Ghost were forcefully brought to the Synod, it would likely be Processed and be detained by the Moros police.

This setup gives you a highly playable, social "City of the Dead." It allows for court dramas (Nomos), heist missions for information (Vestus), and evasion/combat encounters (Moros), all set against a backdrop of the world's greatest lost architecture.